

FORMULA 1

**2026
SEASON**

The Tracks of Formula 1

A Beginner's Guide to Formula 1

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Formula 1 races at some of the most famous circuits in the world. Each track has its own character, challenges, and history. This guide covers the most notable circuits on the 2026 calendar.

Circuit de Monaco

Location	Length	Turns	Type
Monte Carlo, Monaco	3.337 km (shortest on calendar)	19	Street Circuit

Lap Record: 1:12.909 (Lewis Hamilton, 2021)

The crown jewel of F1. This tight street circuit winds through the streets of Monte Carlo, past the famous Casino and along the harbor. Overtaking is nearly impossible, making qualifying and strategy crucial. It's the most prestigious race on the calendar, held since 1929.

Famous Sections: Casino Square (sharp hairpin after uphill climb), the Tunnel (unique light-to-dark transition at high speed), the Swimming Pool chicane (ultra-tight at the harbor), Rascasse (penultimate corner, slow hairpin).

Overtaking: Extremely limited. The Nouvelle Chicane after the tunnel is the only realistic overtaking spot. Track position is everything at Monaco.

Silverstone Circuit

Location	Length	Turns	Type
Silverstone, United Kingdom	5.891 km	18	Permanent Circuit

Lap Record: 1:27.097 (Max Verstappen, 2020)

The home of British motorsport and where the first-ever Formula 1 World Championship race was held in 1950. Silverstone is one of the fastest circuits on the calendar, known for its high-speed corners that test aerodynamic performance.

Famous Sections: Maggotts-Becketts-Chapel (legendary high-speed S-curves, the ultimate test of car balance and driver courage), Copse (fast right-hander), Stowe (high-speed braking zone).

Overtaking: Good opportunities at the end of the Wellington Straight into Brooklands and at the end of the Hangar Straight into Stowe. Active aero will be especially effective on the long straights.

Spa-Francorchamps

Location	Length	Turns	Type
Stavelot, Belgium	7.004 km (longest on calendar)	19	Permanent Circuit

Lap Record: 1:44.701 (Sergio Perez, 2024)

The longest and one of the most dramatic circuits in F1. Set in the Ardennes forest, Spa features dramatic elevation changes and is famous for unpredictable weather. It can rain on one part of the circuit while the sun shines on another.

Famous Sections: Eau Rouge / Raidillon (iconic uphill left-right-left sequence taken at over 300 km/h), La Source (tight hairpin at the start), Blanchimont (flat-out left kink at extreme speed), Bus Stop chicane.

Overtaking: Excellent opportunities. The long Kemmel Straight after Eau Rouge is one of the best overtaking spots in F1. Additional chances into La Source and at the Bus Stop chicane.

Circuit Guide (continued)

Autodromo Nazionale Monza

Location	Length	Turns	Type
Monza, Italy	5.793 km	11	Permanent Circuit

Lap Record: 1:20.901 (Lando Norris, 2025)

The 'Temple of Speed,' the fastest circuit on the calendar with average speeds exceeding 260 km/h. Home of the Italian Grand Prix since 1950, Monza is Ferrari's home race and the Tifosi create an unforgettable atmosphere.

Famous Sections: Curva Grande (long, sweeping right-hander), the two Lesmo corners, Variante Ascari (fast chicane), Parabolica/Curva Alboreto (long right-hander leading onto the main straight).

Overtaking: Plentiful. The three chicanes all offer heavy braking zones. Slipstreaming on the long straights is a key tactic.

Suzuka Circuit

Location	Length	Turns	Type
Suzuka, Japan	5.807 km	18	Permanent Circuit

Lap Record: 1:30.983 (Lewis Hamilton, 2019)

One of the most technically demanding circuits in F1 and the only figure-of-eight layout on the calendar (the track crosses over itself via an overpass). Suzuka is revered by drivers for its flowing, high-speed nature.

Famous Sections: The Esses (S-curves from turns 3-7, a breathtaking high-speed sequence), Degner curves, Spoon curve (double-apex left-hander), 130R (one of the fastest corners in F1), the Casio Triangle chicane.

Overtaking: Moderate. Main opportunities at the end of the back straight into the Casio Triangle and at Turn 1.

Circuit of the Americas (COTA)

Location	Length	Turns	Type
Austin, Texas, USA	5.513 km	20	Permanent Circuit

Lap Record: 1:36.169 (Charles Leclerc, 2019)

Purpose-built for F1 and opened in 2012, COTA combines design elements from great circuits worldwide. The dramatic uphill run to Turn 1 is one of F1's most exciting starts. A cornerstone of F1's growing American fanbase.

Famous Sections: Turn 1 (steep uphill blind apex, crucial for race starts), the Esses at turns 3-6 (inspired by Silverstone), Turn 11 (hairpin, key overtaking point), the stadium section (turns 16-18).

Overtaking: Good opportunities at Turn 1 (especially on lap 1), Turn 12 (end of back straight), and Turn 15.

Circuit Guide (continued)

Jeddah Corniche Circuit

Location	Length	Turns	Type
Jeddah, Saudi Arabia	6.174 km	27	Street Circuit

Lap Record: 1:30.734 (Lewis Hamilton, 2021)

The fastest street circuit in F1 history, averaging over 250 km/h. Jeddah's layout runs along the Red Sea waterfront with walls on both sides at extreme speed. High-risk, high-reward with limited visibility through several blind corners.

Famous Sections: Turn 1 (fast entry), the sweeping section from turns 4-12 (high-speed flowing sequence near the coast), Turn 22 (fast kink near the walls), the tight final sector.

Overtaking: Reasonable opportunities on the main straight and at the end of sector 2's long blast.

Marina Bay Street Circuit

Location	Length	Turns	Type
Singapore	4.940 km	19	Street Circuit

Lap Record: 1:35.867 (Lewis Hamilton, 2023)

F1's original night race, held under floodlights in the heart of Singapore's financial district. One of the most physically demanding races: heat, humidity, bumpy surfaces, and nearly 2 hours of racing make it an endurance test.

Famous Sections: Turn 5 (tight left-hander by the Esplanade), the Anderson Bridge section (turns 7-8), Turn 14 (under the Singapore Flyer), Turn 16-17 (by Marina Bay Sands).

Overtaking: Limited but possible. Main straight into Turn 1 is the best chance. Strategy and safety car timing are often decisive.

Madrid Street Circuit

Location	Length	Turns	Type
Madrid, Spain	5.473 km (estimated)	~20 (estimated)	Street Circuit (NEW)

The newest addition to the F1 calendar for 2026. Madrid's purpose-built circuit runs through the IFEMA exhibition complex area near the airport. With Barcelona also remaining on the calendar, Spain now boasts two Grands Prix.

Famous Sections: Details of corner names and character will emerge during the inaugural event. The circuit is designed to provide a mix of high-speed straights and technical sections.

Overtaking: As a purpose-designed modern venue, the Madrid circuit is expected to include good overtaking opportunities with long straights and heavy braking zones.

What to Watch For at Each Race

Circuit Type	Characteristics	Key Factors
Street Circuits (Monaco, Singapore, Jeddah, Madrid)	Tight, barriers close, limited runoff	Qualifying position is critical; safety cars common
Power Circuits (Monza, Jeddah, Spa)	High top speeds, long straights	X-mode has maximum impact; slipstreaming key

High-Downforce Circuits (Monaco, Singapore, Budapest)	Cornering speed matters most	Overtaking harder; strategy crucial
Mixed Circuits (Silverstone, COTA, Suzuka)	All-round car balance rewarded	Good for close racing across the field
Weather-Sensitive Venues (Spa, Silverstone, Suzuka, Singapore)	Rain can appear quickly	Dramatic strategy decisions

Elevation and Altitude

Some circuits have significant elevation changes (Spa, COTA) that test suspension and aero. High-altitude venues like Mexico City (2,240m) reduce engine power and aero effectiveness due to thinner air, making them unique engineering challenges.